Anatomy of a Prompt

The six building blocks behind every strong prompt.

USE IT WHEN You want structured help on any task and need a reliable checklist for what to include.

THE SIX COMPONENTS

1 Role

Who the AI should act as. Be specific about expertise and experience level.

2 Task

The exact deliverable plus success criteria. What does done look like?

3 Context

Audience, background, goal, requirements, constraints, tone, and style.

4 Reasoning

Think step by step, check facts, and show only brief reasoning.

5 Output format

Bullets, numbered list, table, or narrative. Spell out the structure.

6 Stop conditions

Word or bullet limits, exclusions, and how to end the response.

COPY AND FILL IN

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ROLE: [who the AI should act as]
TASK: [exact deliverable + what success looks like]
CONTEXT: [audience, background, constraints, tone]
REASONING: Think step by step. Flag anything you are unsure of.
OUTPUT FORMAT: [bullets / numbered list / table / narrative]
STOP CONDITIONS: [length limit, what to leave out, how to end]
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! Most overlooked component

Stop conditions. Telling the AI exactly when and how to end prevents bloated, over-explained answers and keeps the output actionable.